- Is it going to be implemented as a raw chunk of memory, or as an object? And what attributes will it hold?

Even for such a basic data structure as arrays, different programming languages make different choices with respect to the questions above. But all of them make sure their version of arrays abides by the array's ADT we described above.

Another good example to understand the difference might be a stack: we will describe stacks in appendices C and D, but I assume you likely have heard of stacks before.

A possible description of a stack as an ADT is the following: "a container that can store an indefinite number of elements, and can remove elements one at the time, starting from the most recent, according to the inverse order of insertion".

An alternative description could break down the actions that can be performed on the container: a stack is a container that supports two main methods:

1. Insertion of an element.
2. Removal of an element: if the stack is not empty, the element that was added the latest will be removed from the stack and returned.

It's still high level, but clearer and more modular than the previous one.